INSTRUCTIONAL AREA
Communication Skills

PRINCIPLES OF HOSPITALITY AND TOURISM

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "This event is presented to you through your review of the Career Competencies, Performance Indicators and Event Situation."
- "You have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. Using the materials provided, you may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 10 minutes to present to the judge(s)."
- "You will be evaluated on your solution to the event situation, how you incorporate the performance indicators of this event and how you demonstrate the career competencies."
- "Turn in all your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

SOLUTION

- Unique – Demonstrate original thinking, fresh perspectives and an insightful approach.
- Practical – Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.
- Effective – Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes.

CAREER COMPETENCIES

- Critical Thinking – Think critically to understand and solve problems.
- Communication – Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.
- Decision Making – Consider the impacts of decisions.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Explain the nature of effective written communications.
2. Explain the nature of effective verbal communications.
3. Choose and use appropriate channel for workplace communication.
4. Write informational messages.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the role of a guest services associate at SUMMIT RIDGE RESORT, a ski resort in the Rocky Mountains. The guest services manager (judge) has asked you to decide how to best inform guests that the resort's main chairlift is closed.

The Ridgeline Express is the resort's most popular chairlift. A mechanical problem was found last week, and the lift will be closed for 10 days for repairs during the resort's busiest week of the year. Guests can still reach the top of the mountain by taking a free shuttle bus or by riding two slower chairlifts.

Right now, the only notice of the closure is a small sign at the bottom of the lift. Guests are frustrated, and employees have been giving guests different answers about when the lift will reopen. The guest services manager (judge) wants you to decide which methods to use to tell guests about the closure, what the message should say, and how employees should respond when guests ask about it.

You will present your ideas to the guest services manager (judge) in a role-play to take place in the manager's office. The guest services manager (judge) will begin the role-play by greeting you and asking to hear your ideas. After you have presented your ideas and have answered the guest services manager's (judge's) questions, the guest services manager (judge) will conclude the role-play by thanking you for your work.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. Which method will reach guests before they get to the lift, and why?
2. What should we do if the repair takes longer than 10 days?

Rate the participant's ability to:		Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Explain the nature of effective written communications.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9-10-11	12	
2.	Explain the nature of effective verbal communications.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9-10-11	12	
3.	Choose and use appropriate channel for workplace communication.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9-10-11	12	
4.	Write informational messages.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9-10-11	12	
SOLUTION						
4.	**Unique** Demonstrate original thinking, fresh perspectives and an insightful approach.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
5.	**Practical** Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
6.	**Effective** Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAEREER COMPETANCIES						
7.	**Critical Thinking** Think critically to understand and solve problems	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
8.	**Communication** Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
9.	**Decision Making** Consider the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSIONS						
10.	Demonstrate overall career readiness through professionalism, poise and confidence.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
					TOTAL SCORE	